Proofhold

A PayPal payment held until the agreed proof arrives.

PAYPAL AI HACKATHON · PROOFHOLD.ONRENDER.COM

01 · THE PROBLEM

Paying a stranger for work is an act of faith.

Freelancers get paid late or not at all. Buyers who pay up front get burned. The tools in between do not settle it.

INVOICE

Enforces nothing

It asks for money after the work. If the buyer goes quiet, the seller has a PDF.

ESCROW

Takes custody and a fee

A third party holds the money and decides by its own policy when to let go.

MARKETPLACE

Takes a cut and the relationship

Protection comes bundled with a platform both sides have to move onto.

02 · THE INSIGHT

PayPal can already hold money without anyone taking custody.

An authorization reserves the amount in the buyer's own account for up to 29 days.
Nothing has been paid, and only a capture moves it.

Proofhold binds that hold to a definition of “done” that both sides signed.

03 · HOW IT WORKS

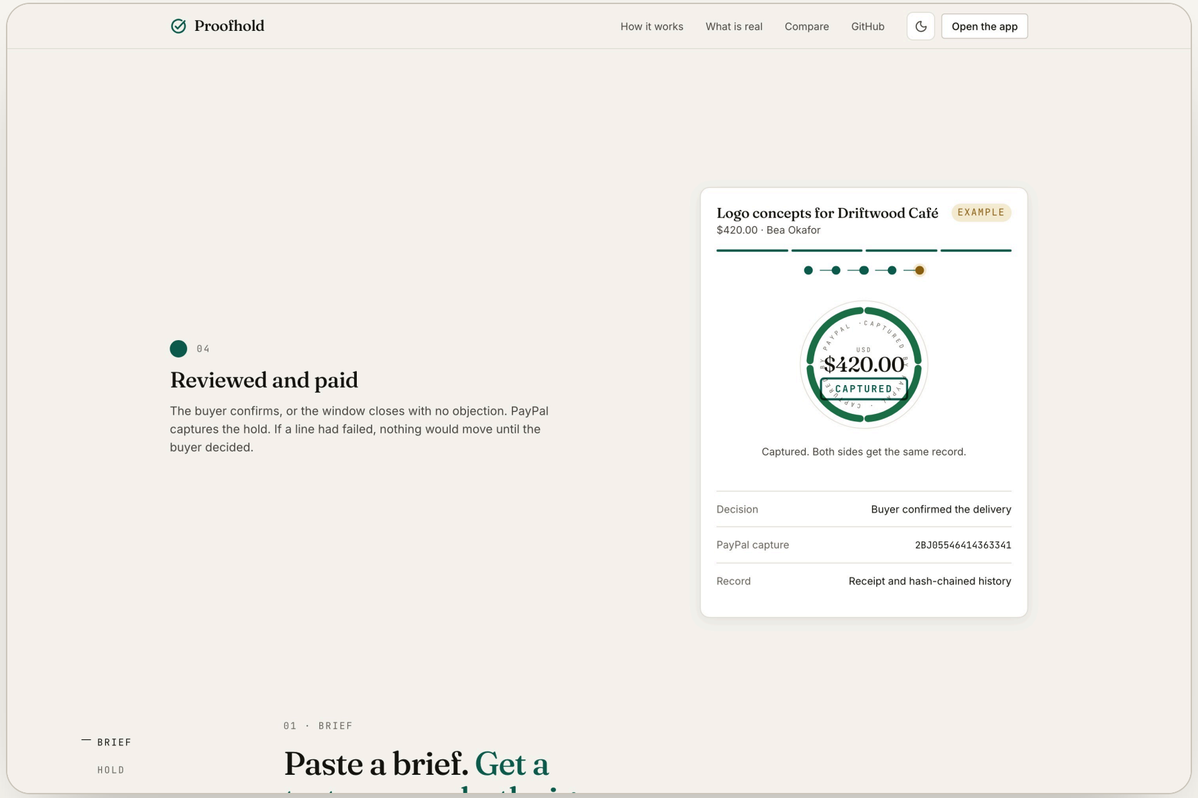
One agreement, four moments.

01 **Agreed.** The seller writes a brief. AI compiles it into an acceptance test both sides read.

02 **Payment authorized.** The buyer approves a PayPal hold. The test's hash is written into the order.

03 **Work delivered.** Validators measure the files. An examiner judges only what a machine cannot.

04 **Reviewed and paid.** The buyer confirms, or the window closes. PayPal captures.

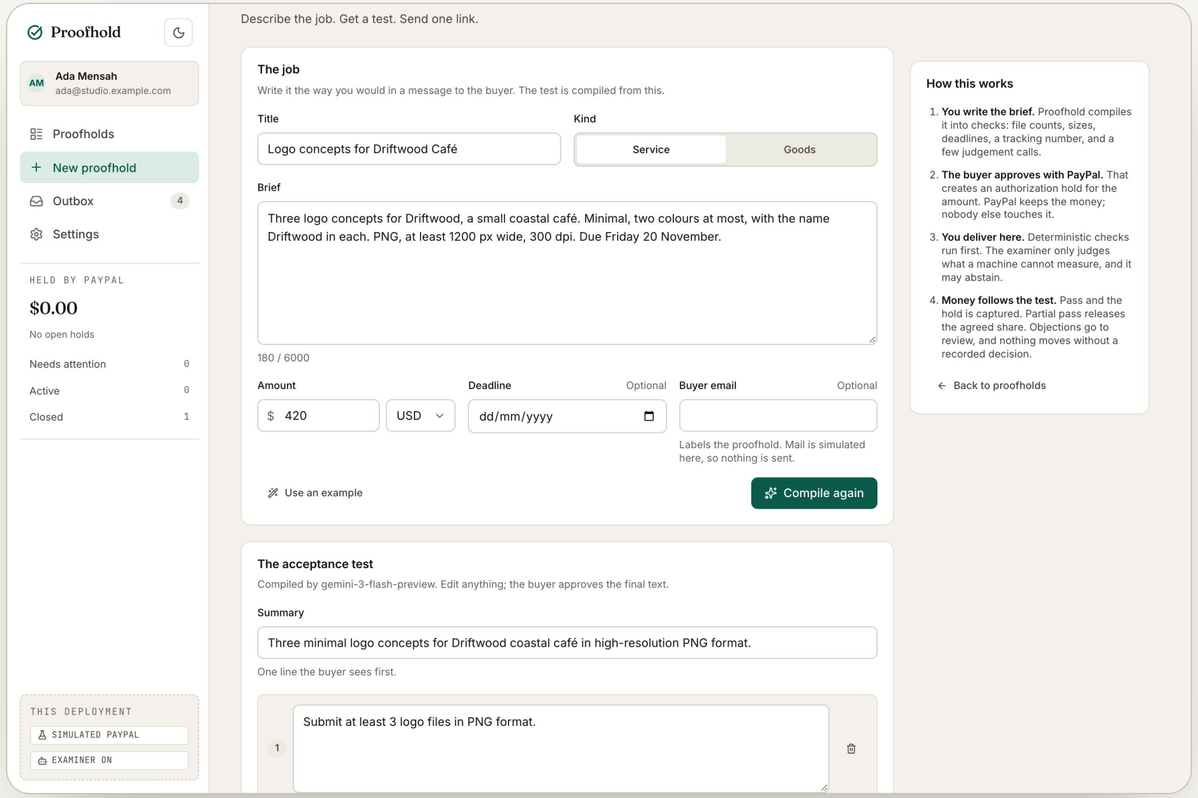


04 · AI, PART ONE

A brief becomes a test you can both sign.

Gemini reads plain words and writes down what “done” means: how many files, what size, by when, and the few judgement calls a human would make.

It lists what the brief left unclear instead of guessing, and the seller can edit every line.

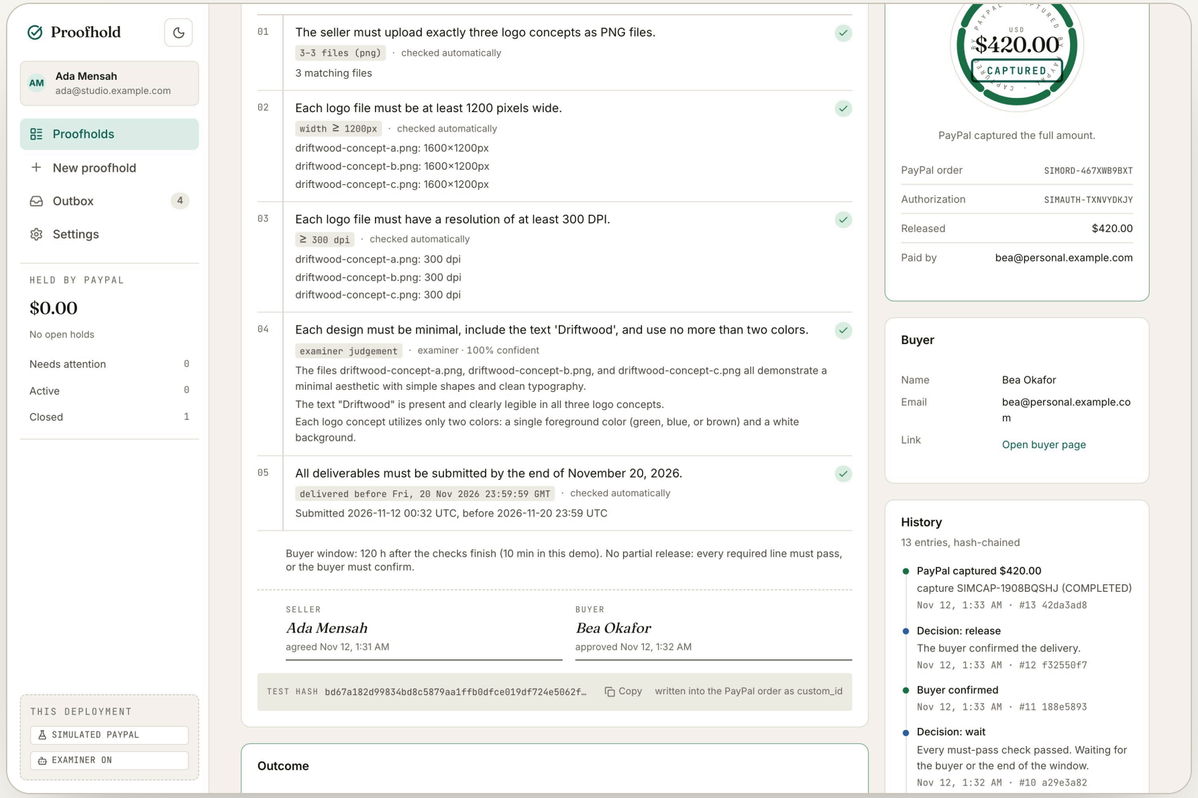


05 · AI, PART TWO

Every line says who decided it, and why.

Checks a machine can make are made from the bytes. The examiner judges the rest, gives reasons that cite the files, and may abstain.

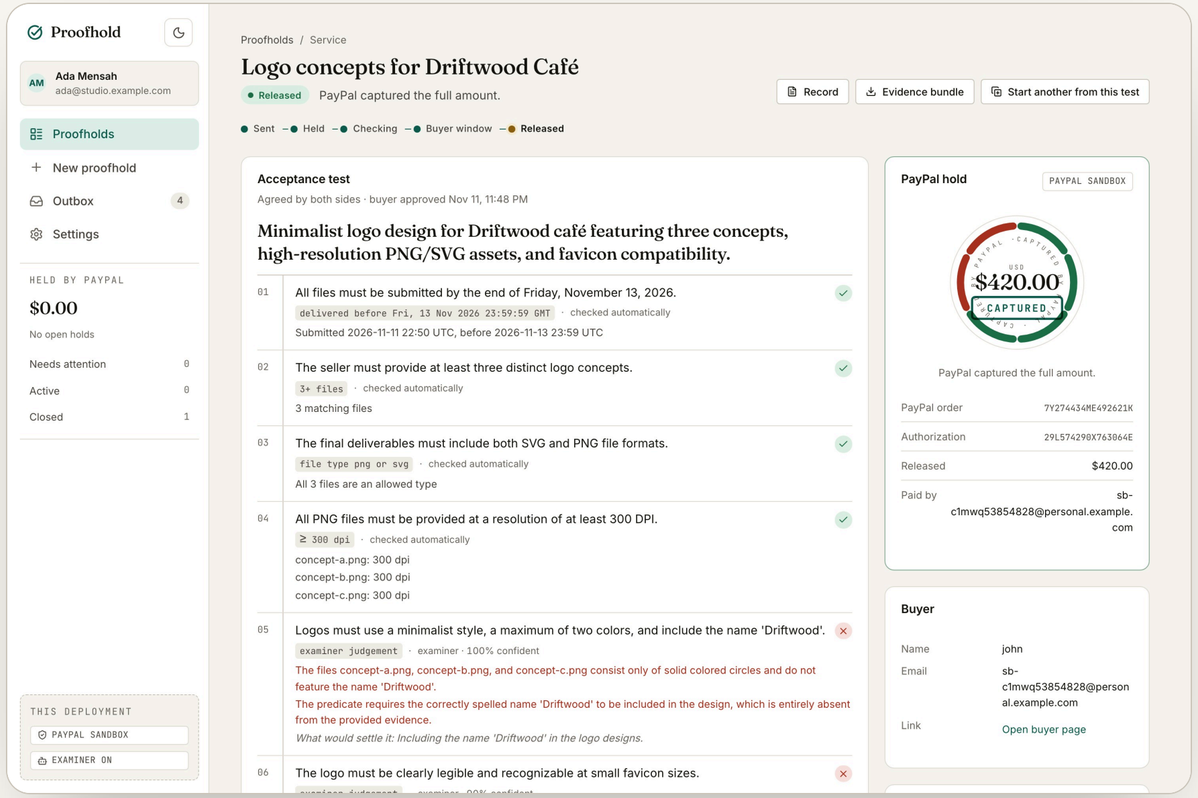
> **The model never moves money.** A decision engine does, and an abstention never releases a hold. The buyer's word outranks the model.



Run against the PayPal sandbox.

ORDERS V2	intent AUTHORIZE, with the test's hash as `custom_id`
PAYMENTS V2	capture, partial capture, void, reauthorize, refund
DISPUTES	the evidence bundle filed for the seller
TRACKING	carrier number attached to the captured order
WEBHOOKS	verified, with reconciliation as the fallback

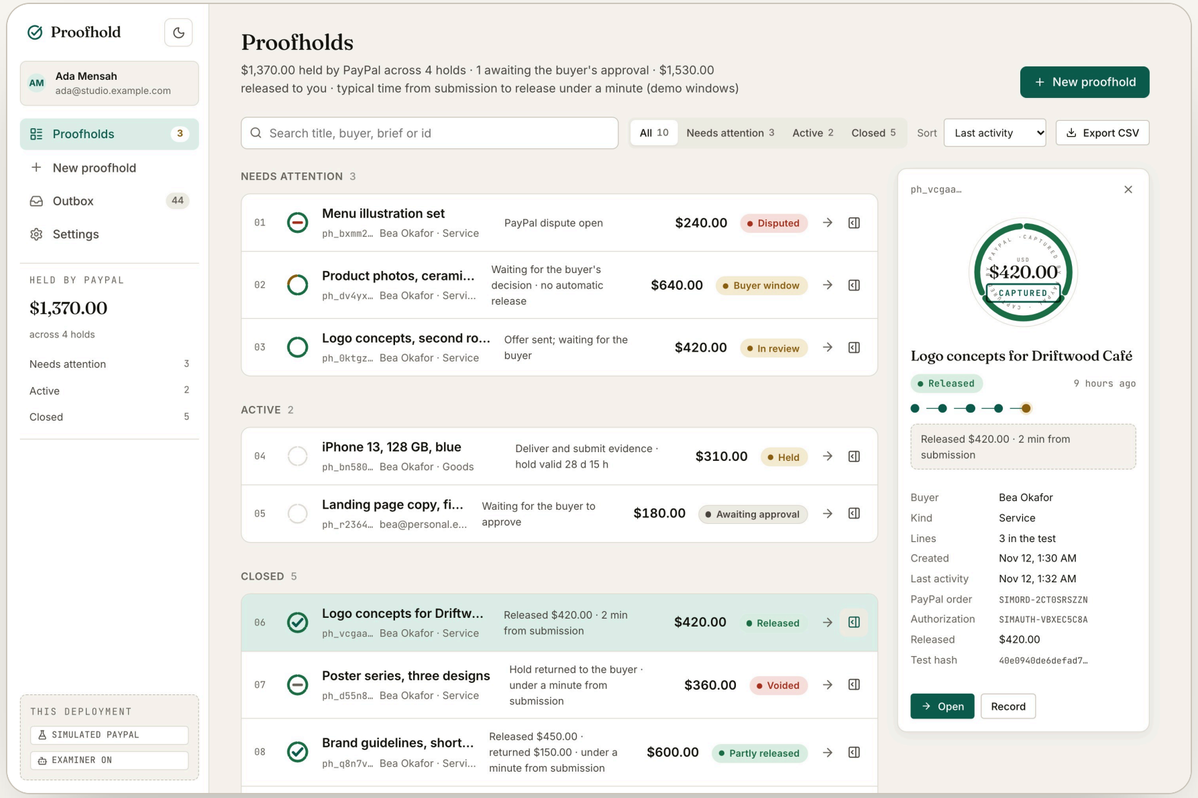
`order 7Y274434ME492621K · authorization 29L574290X763064E · capture 2BJ05546414363341`



07 · A COMPLETE PRODUCT

Built for the people on both sides.

- A ledger of every hold, with search, export and an inspector
- A buyer page that shows the delivery and the checks before the decision
- Objection, partial release, and return of the hold
- A printable record and a hash-chained history for both parties
- Light and dark themes, phone layouts, an accessibility scan in CI



08 · WHAT IS REAL

Honest about what has been proven.

VERIFIED

Run for real

PayPal sandbox: order, approval, authorization, full capture, partial capture, void. Gemini compiling briefs and judging uploads. Postgres on the hosted demo.

TESTED

155 unit tests, 4 journeys

Browser journeys for release, goods, objection and dispute, and an accessibility scan on eleven routes in both themes, all in CI.

NOT YET

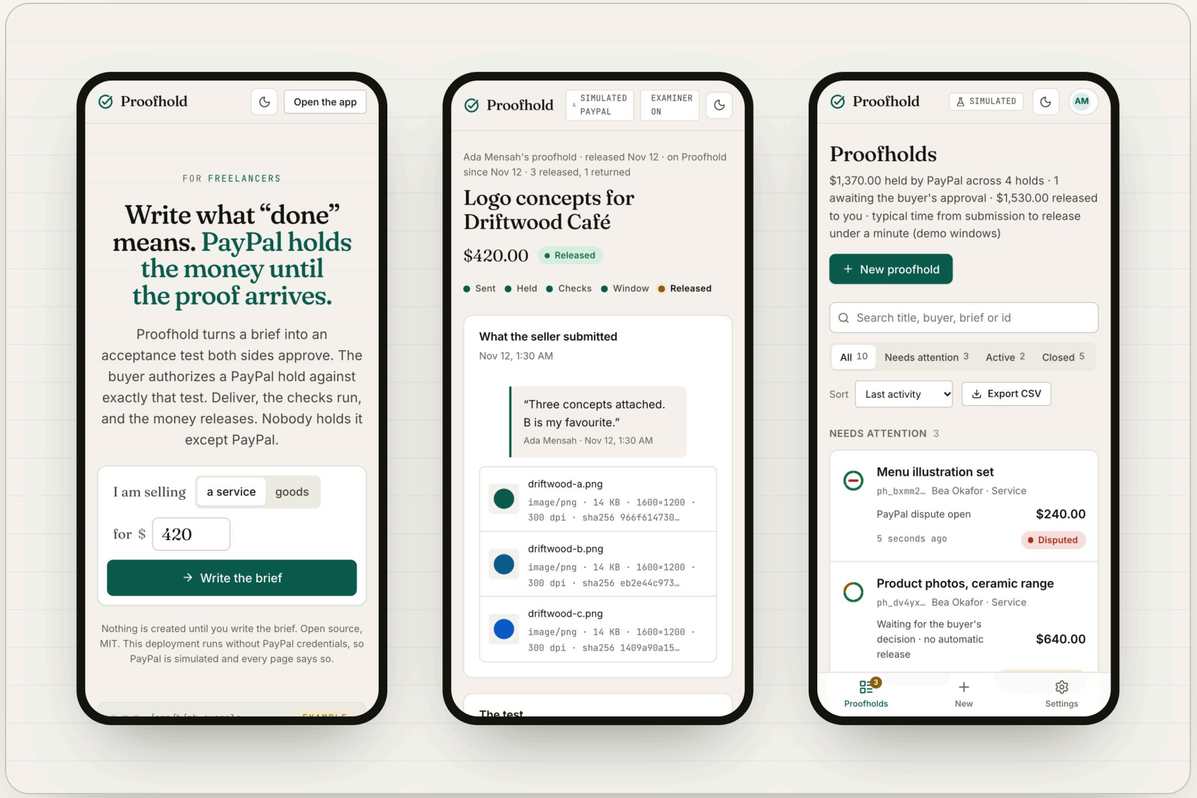
Said plainly

Reauthorize, refund, tracking and disputes run only on the simulator. The examiner's accuracy is unmeasured. Payouts go to one PayPal business account.

09 · DESIGN

The test is a document. The hold is a seal on it.

One ring arc per line of the test, coloured by its verdict, stamped when money moves. The same seal appears on the seller's page, the buyer's page and the receipt.



Proofhold

Write what “done” means. PayPal holds the money until the proof arrives.

LIVE DEMO
proofhold.onrender.com

CODE, MIT
github.com/successaje/proofhold

VIDEO
youtu.be/z0C_gWOIWqU